

Major School Syllabus

Officer Formation Level III

Course purpose. Major School forms the officer who can be trusted with wider oversight. It is the transition from local commander to regional steward: a man who can strengthen multiple bodies, inspect standards, develop captains, align operations across a broader structure, and preserve the health of the Order beyond one local command.

Historical Foundation

The historical model for Major School is the **Provincial Master / Grand Prior**. In the Templar hierarchy, Provincial Masters governed European districts and were largely responsible for **managing revenue and recruiting new men to the Order**, while also standing above the local commanders of commanderies and preceptories. This office provides the clearest historical parallel for a rank charged with wider oversight, stronger systems, and the development of multiple commands.

Course-Wide Learning Objectives

Objective Area	Course-Wide Objective
Templar identity	Explain how Templar provincial leadership functioned and why regional oversight was essential to the stability and expansion of the Order.
Officer responsibility	Describe the role of a Major as a steward of multiple bodies, developing leaders, standards, and systems across a wider structure.
Leadership under authority	Demonstrate the ability to oversee captains and local bodies in alignment with the mission and higher authority of the Order.
Character formation	Practice restraint, prudence, disciplined speech, humility, and justice while carrying broader responsibility.
Leader development	Evaluate, coach, and strengthen captains and emerging officers through structured support and accountability.
Promotion readiness	Show evidence of readiness for senior command through regional assessment, leader development, and final board review.

12-Lesson Syllabus Overview

Lesson	Title	Learning Objectives	Assignment	
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				Leadership Outcome
1	The Burden of Wider Oversight	Define the purpose of Major School; explain the shift from governing one body to strengthening several; identify the responsibilities of a Major in your Order.	1-2 page reflection: "What changes when an officer becomes responsible for the health of multiple bodies?"	Begins to think like a steward of systems, leaders, and regional mission.
2	The Provincial Structure of the Templars	Summarize how Templar provinces functioned; explain why regional leadership was essential to growth, continuity, and accountability.	Short presentation or visual summary on Templar provincial structure.	Understands the historical model of district oversight.
3	The Office of Provincial Master / Grand Prior	Describe the duties of Provincial Masters in governing districts, managing resources, and recruiting; connect those duties to your Major rank.	2-page comparison: "The Templar Provincial Master and the modern Major in our Order."	Sees Major as a true oversight office, not simply a senior local officer.
4	Mission Alignment Across Multiple Bodies	Explain how different local bodies remain faithful to one Order-wide mission without losing effectiveness; define the Major's role in preserving unity.	Draft a one-page regional alignment statement covering mission, standards, and common expectations.	Understands how to unify multiple commands without flattening them.
5	Inspection, Accountability, and Standards	Learn how oversight protects a healthy Order; apply Templar principles of authority and accountability to inspections, reviews, and corrective support.	Build a local-body assessment template for evaluating standards, leadership health, and operational readiness.	Grows in objective evaluation and disciplined accountability.
6	Recruitment, Growth, and Officer Pipeline	Understand the historical provincial role in recruitment; apply that model to membership growth, officer development, and long-term strength.	Create a 6-month regional growth and officer-development plan.	Thinks beyond maintenance and begins leading for future strength.

7	Resource Stewardship and Regional Planning	Connect the historical duty of managing revenue and resources to modern planning, prioritization, support, and allocation across multiple bodies.	Build a regional support and priority map showing needs, risks, and development areas.	Grows in strategic stewardship and prudent planning.
8	Training Captains and Strengthening Local Command	Learn how a Major supports, evaluates, and develops captains; identify ways to coach without micromanaging.	Conduct a structured leadership review with a Captain or simulated case and submit findings.	Becomes a builder of stronger local commanders.
9	Communication, Coordination, and Order	Apply disciplined speech, clarity, and restraint to regional communication; learn how to coordinate multiple bodies without confusion or corrosive tone.	Draft a regional communication protocol for reporting, updates, and issue escalation.	Develops calm, clear, and orderly oversight communication.
10	Correction, Intervention, and Restoration at the Regional Level	Learn how to address drift, weak leadership, conflict, or underperformance across several bodies while preserving justice and fraternity.	Write case-study responses to three regional-oversight scenarios involving correction or intervention.	Learns to intervene lawfully, firmly, and constructively.
11	Regional Oversight Practicum	Demonstrate the ability to evaluate and strengthen one or more local bodies through a real or simulated regional assignment.	Lead an approved regional assessment or support project and submit an after-action review.	Proves he can operate as a real oversight officer.
12	Capstone Preparation and Major's Board Review	Integrate course learning; prepare for final portfolio, practicum review, and oral board.	Submit final portfolio: reflections, assessment tools, development plans, practicum summary, and self-assessment.	Demonstrates readiness for high-level oversight and preparation for senior command.

Lesson Details

Lesson 1 — The Burden of Wider Oversight

Focus: The Major leads by oversight, evaluation, support, and strategic alignment across multiple bodies rather than direct command of only one.

Leadership emphasis: A Major is accountable not merely for one command's performance, but for whether strength, discipline, and health are being multiplied across the region.

Assignment: 1–2 page reflection on responsibility for multiple bodies.

Lesson 2 — The Provincial Structure of the Templars

Focus: Provinces within the Templar Order connected local houses to the larger authority of the Order and preserved coherence across different locations.

Leadership emphasis: Growth without structure weakens an order; provincial leadership binds expansion to mission.

Assignment: Presentation or visual summary on Templar provincial structure.

Lesson 3 — The Office of Provincial Master / Grand Prior

Focus: The Provincial Master as the historical model for Major, governing districts, recruiting, and managing resources while standing over subordinate local commanders.

Leadership emphasis: Major-level leadership is not simply “more Captaincy”; it is a different kind of office requiring broader judgment and indirect influence.

Assignment: Comparison paper between the Templar Provincial Master and your Major rank.

Lesson 4 — Mission Alignment Across Multiple Bodies

Focus: Keeping several local bodies faithful to one mission while retaining practical effectiveness in different circumstances.

Leadership emphasis: Unity is not sameness, but shared direction under one mission and one rule of life.

Assignment: Regional alignment statement on mission, standards, and common expectations.

Lesson 5 — Inspection, Accountability, and Standards

Focus: Oversight, inspections, reviews, and corrective support that preserve health without becoming punitive or bureaucratic.

Leadership emphasis: Inspection exists to preserve mission and strengthen bodies, not merely to find faults.

Assignment: Local-body assessment template.

Lesson 6 — Recruitment, Growth, and Officer Pipeline

Focus: Building future strength through recruitment, officer development, and long-range pipeline planning.

Leadership emphasis: The regional officer must build tomorrow's strength, not merely manage today's activity.

Assignment: 6-month regional growth and officer-development plan.

Lesson 7 — Resource Stewardship and Regional Planning

Focus: Managing priorities, support, and resource alignment across multiple bodies.

Leadership emphasis: Stewardship at this level requires discernment, not merely distribution.

Assignment: Regional support and priority map.

Lesson 8 — Training Captains and Strengthening Local Command

Focus: Developing captains through support, evaluation, and coaching without micromanagement.

Leadership emphasis: The Major's success is visible in stronger captains, not in tighter personal control.

Assignment: Structured leadership review with findings and recommendations.

Lesson 9 — Communication, Coordination, and Order

Focus: Disciplined speech, restraint, and clear communication across multiple levels of leadership.

Leadership emphasis: The Major's words should create clarity, calm, and order across the region.

Assignment: Regional communication protocol.

Lesson 10 — Correction, Intervention, and Restoration at the Regional Level

Focus: Responding to drift, weak leadership, slipping standards, or growing conflict in a lawful and constructive way.

Leadership emphasis: Intervention should be lawful, proportionate, and ordered toward restoration whenever possible.

Assignment: Regional oversight case studies.

Lesson 11 — Regional Oversight Practicum

Focus: Demonstrating assessment, support, coordination, and strengthening of more than one body through a real or simulated assignment.

Leadership emphasis: Oversight must be demonstrated through action, judgment, and measurable strengthening of the bodies involved.

Assignment: Approved regional assessment or support project with after-action review.

Lesson 12 — Capstone Preparation and Major's Board Review

Focus: Integrating course learning for final portfolio and oral board focused on regional stewardship and future senior leadership.

Leadership emphasis: Readiness for Major must be visible in judgment, systems thinking, character, and leader development.

Assignment: Final portfolio submission.

Required Assignments Summary

Assignment	Purpose
Reflection on the burden of wider oversight	Clarify the candidate's understanding of responsibility for multiple bodies.
Templar provincial structure presentation	Establish historical understanding of district-level leadership.
Provincial Master comparison paper	Link the historical office to the Major rank.
Regional alignment statement	Build unity of mission and standards across multiple bodies.
Local-body assessment template	Form practical oversight and accountability skill.
Regional growth and officer-development plan	Build long-range recruitment and pipeline thinking.
Regional support and priority map	Develop resource stewardship and strategic planning.
Structured Captain leadership review	Practice evaluating and strengthening local commanders.
Regional communication protocol	Build clarity, order, and disciplined oversight communication.
Regional oversight case-study paper	Form judgment in intervention and correction.
Regional practicum and AAR	Demonstrate applied regional leadership.
Final portfolio	Integrate all work for board review.

Leadership Outcomes

Leadership Domain	Expected Outcome
Identity	Understands the Templar provincial model and the meaning of district-level oversight.
Stewardship	Demonstrates responsibility for multiple bodies, shared standards, and regional strength.
Discipline	Shows prudence, consistency, objectivity, and orderly oversight practice.
Obedience	Exercises wider authority in alignment with the mission and higher leadership of the Order.
Humility	

	Oversees others without vanity, insecurity, or the need for constant personal control.
Speech and tone	Communicates with clarity, restraint, and maturity across multiple levels of leadership.
Care of the brotherhood	Can identify struggling bodies, leaders, or members and respond constructively.
Leader development	Strengthens captains and builds a healthier officer pipeline.
Execution	Can assess, coordinate, and improve more than one body through a structured approach.
Promotion readiness	Shows evidence of fitness for senior command and broader institutional stewardship.

Final Evaluation

Component	Weight	What is assessed
Attendance and participation	10%	Presence, preparedness, engagement, and contribution to discussion.
Written assignments	20%	Historical understanding, reflection quality, and strategic application.
Assessment / planning assignments	10%	Quality of oversight tools, alignment thinking, and planning discipline.
Leader-development assignments	10%	Ability to evaluate, coach, and strengthen captains and future officers.
Regional oversight practicum	20%	Leadership judgment, coordination, evaluation, communication, and follow-through.
Senior observation	10%	Bearing, humility, discipline, fairness, and maturity in wider responsibility.
Final portfolio	10%	Integration, completeness, self-awareness, and oversight readiness.
Oral board / final review	10%	Officer presence, judgment, historical grounding, and readiness for Major-level office.

Sample Oral Board Questions

- Why were Provincial Masters essential to the historical Templar Order?
- What distinguishes a Major from a Captain in your Order?
- Why is the Provincial Master / Grand Prior the right model for Major School?
- What must a Major protect across multiple bodies besides outward activity?

- How do you inspect and correct without becoming merely punitive or bureaucratic?
- How do you know whether a Captain is healthy, stagnant, or failing?
- What kind of speech most harms a region, and how should a Major prevent it?
- How do you decide where limited time and support should be concentrated?
- Where is your greatest weakness as a future Major, and how are you addressing it?
- Why are you ready—or not yet ready—for wider oversight?

Practicum Requirement

The candidate must complete one approved regional oversight practicum, such as conducting a structured review of one or more local bodies, coordinating a regional officer-development effort, building a district growth and mentoring plan, leading a support initiative for a struggling local command, or designing and applying a regional accountability or communication system. The practicum should include supervisor observation and an after-action review.

Promotion Recommendation Standard

A candidate should be recommended only if he completes the course requirements, demonstrates disciplined and measured conduct, shows competence in oversight, planning, and leader development, leads the practicum successfully, passes the oral board, and proves he can strengthen multiple bodies rather than merely excel in one local setting.

Historical sources used in drafting this syllabus:

Wikipedia — Knights Templar: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Knights_Templar

Medieval Warfare — Templars hierarchy and duties: <https://www.medievalwarfare.info/templars.htm>

Medieval Warfare — Primitive Rule of the Templars: <https://www.medievalwarfare.info/rule.htm>